Gunther Scherz

General Manager | Country Manager | Interim and Turnaround Leadership, Asia Pacific

Singapore | +65 9011 3994 | gunther.scherz@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/gunther-scherz

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

General Manager and country leader with 25 years of full P&L ownership in Asia Pacific, from founder-led start-ups to a US$38 million manufacturing subsidiary. A career built on fixing and building rather than administering: a distressed, loss-making Indonesian subsidiary returned to profit; a Singapore healthcare practice built into a premium brand at a sustained double-digit net margin; a technology company exited at 7 times EBITDA. Austrian by origin, Singaporean by citizenship and a German native speaker: a working bridge between European head offices and Asian operations. Open to executive, interim and consulting mandates across Asia Pacific, with no work permit constraints.

CORE COMPETENCIES

General Management: Turnaround and restructuring | Interim and transition leadership | Full P&L ownership | Multi-country leadership

Commercial: Go-to-market and market entry | Distributor, dealer and channel management | Pricing

Growth and Margin: Revenue growth | EBITDA improvement | Cost, OPEX and working capital control

Operations: Procurement and vendor negotiation | Supply chain and inventory | HR and payroll

Corporate: M&A, due diligence and exit | Joint ventures and buy-outs | Board and governance

Healthcare: Clinical governance | MOH compliance | Clinical research, IRB and ethics approval

Systems: NetSuite and IDS ERP | Xero | Plato EMR | Eber loyalty | respond.io | CRM and digital

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Managing Director and Co-Founder

Cutis Medical Laser Clinics Pte Ltd, Singapore | 2007 to Present

- Founded and scaled a premium medical aesthetics practice with a team of 14 at a sustained double-digit net margin, holding full P&L, budgeting, forecasting and capital accountability.
- Own the complete operating stack across commercial strategy, pricing, procurement and vendor negotiation, HR and payroll, inventory and facilities; run accounting, inventory and management reporting on Xero, previously on NetSuite ERP.
- Designed a three-tier membership model (VIP, Platinum, PPS) built on customer lifetime value rather than transaction volume, with loyalty and membership tracking run on the Eber platform and integrated with the EMR.
- Opened a second revenue line, Cutis Essential, a non-medical service pathway that widened patient access, plus a private-label skincare range now contributing roughly 15 percent of total revenue.
- Implemented the Plato EMR and practice management platform alongside respond.io for AI-enabled lead management and omnichannel patient enquiry handling, lifting operational efficiency 30 percent and cutting marketing spend 24 percent.
- Lead clinical governance and regulatory compliance under Singapore Ministry of Health advertising and practice guidelines; built an award-recognized clinical brand in a tightly regulated market.
- Hold the Ministry of Health designated research organization role for the practice, liaising with the Parkway Independent Ethics Committee (IRB) on submissions and ethics approval for investigator-initiated clinical studies, and backing the team's peer-reviewed research in aesthetic medicine.

Managing Director and Co-Founder

Call Tracking Solutions, Singapore | 2013 to 2016 (held concurrently with Cutis)

- Launched a call-tracking and marketing-analytics business under license from an Australian technology partner and reached profitability within the first year.
- Built the platform on real-time call tracking, multi-channel attribution and visitor analytics, integrated with CRM, bid management and marketing automation.
- Scaled two channels in parallel: a white-label product for digital agencies, and direct enterprise accounts.
- Led the exit end to end: ran due diligence and deal negotiation, and closed the sale to a Malaysian conglomerate in 2016 at 7 times EBITDA.

President Director and Dealer Principal

Proton Edar and Proton Motor, Indonesia | 2011 to 2012

- Appointed into a distressed, loss-making US$38 million subsidiary and returned it to profit: 3,200 units wholesale across 38 sales and service outlets with 65 staff, plus three owned retail outlets producing US$24 million revenue with 185 staff.
- Settled US$1.2 million of outstanding debt within the first year and opened the 3S dealership in Tanjung Duren, West Jakarta.
- Built and deployed a 166-process Dealer Enhancement Program and Dealer Health Check System on the Deloitte Dealer Benchmark, raising baseline dealer margin and profitability.
- Implemented IDS ERP with local sourcing, cutting OPEX 11 percent and duty and stock-holding complexity 7 percent; customer satisfaction rose 9.7 percent and financing margin 10 percent.
- Managed board, principal and regulatory stakeholder relationships across Malaysia and Indonesia; led the team to the 2012 Proton Technical Competition win.

General Manager, Export

Proton Holdings Berhad, Malaysia | 2009 to 2010

- Directed exports across 22 markets including the UAE, Egypt, Syria, the UK, Australia and South East Asia, widening the footprint from 17 countries to 22.
- Redesigned the supply chain to cut order-to-delivery lead time 20 percent and aging stock 70 percent, lifting sales 15 percent.
- Ran importer and distributor relationships, duty optimization and local accessories sourcing; improved net margin at selected dealerships by 2 percent against the Deloitte benchmark.

General Manager, ASEAN and Country Manager

Audi Asia Pacific, Singapore | 2001 to 2007

General Manager, ASEAN | 2005 to 2007

- Led four Country Managers to 28 percent regional sales growth across ASEAN, with full regional P&L and go-to-market accountability.
- Launched the A3 across ASEAN and the A8 in Australia and New Zealand.
- Worked with the German headquarters team to convert the Australian distributor from a joint venture into a wholly owned national sales company, contributing to the buy-out negotiation and integration.

Country Manager, Malaysia, Indonesia and Thailand | 2003 to 2004

- Grew Malaysia sales 150 percent and introduced Audi Dealer Performance Guidelines on the Deloitte Motoring Dealer Benchmark.

Country Manager, Australia and New Zealand | 2001 to 2002

- Delivered 55 percent of total regional volume, took an ROI-focused growth strategy to the Board, and was part of the team that bought out the Australian joint-venture partner.

SELECTED CONSULTING ASSIGNMENTS

J.D. Power Asia Pacific | Contract assignments | June to October 2014

- Senior Consultant, Philippines (September to October 2014): led an Automotive Dealer Sales and Service Audit across 14 Isuzu dealerships, with a two-day site visit at each and completed Commitment Sheets.
- Consultant, Jakarta (June to September 2014): audited sales and service processes at 11 Toyota dealerships within a 20-dealership program, each a three-day assessment plus two-day follow-up, completing the Gemba Handbook and Commitment Sheets.

EDUCATION

Executive MBA, University of Chicago Booth School of Business, Singapore Campus

International Marketing (ERASMUS), Université Paris Dauphine, France

Mag. rer. soc. oec., Leopold-Franzens Universität, Innsbruck, Austria

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

SMU - Project Management Professional (PMP), Common Law, Law of Mergers and Acquisitions | **Corporate Finance Institute** - Forensic Accounting, Corporate Finance Fundamentals, Analyzing Growth Drivers & Business Risks, Capital IQ Fundamentals, Professional Ethics| HarvardX - Fintech | **Squared Online** - Digital Marketing |

Languages: German (native), English (fluent)